

utility as a productivity device. Educational users will appreciate its capability to function as a digital whiteboard for online teaching platforms like Google Meet and Zoom.

You also get an 8-megapixel camera upfront which is decent for your usual work calls, and at the back, we get a 13-megapixel camera that's good enough for document scanning, but don't expect too much from it.

ACCESSORIES

Xiaomi has paid particular attention to the accessory ecosystem. The Focus Keyboard, priced at Rs 8,999, features backlit keys and a responsive trackpad with laptop-like gestures. The Focus Pen is particularly impressive, offering 8192 pressure levels – double that of the Apple Pencil Pro – and including an innovative spotlight feature for presentations.

BATTERY LIFE

Battery life is robust, with the 8850mAh cell delivering approximately 19 hours of mixed usage spread across two days. In our PCMark Battery Life tests, it maintained operation for 7 hours of continuous use. The 45W charging capability ensures quick refuelling, taking about 80 minutes to go from empty to full.

AUDIO

The audio experience has received significant attention, with a quad-speaker setup featuring a volume booster mode that delivers rich, immersive sound surpassing its predecessor's impressive audio quality. While it might not match the eight-speaker setup of some competitors like the Lenovo Tab Plus, it holds its own in the premium tablet segment.

VERDICT

The Xiaomi Pad 7 does have its limitations. The absence of cellular connectivity might disappoint some users, and certain Android apps still haven't been



fully optimized for tablet use. The promised Xiaomi Creation app with AI features is pending an OTA update, though this temporary limitation is outweighed by the tablet's current capabilities.

In conclusion, the Xiaomi Pad 7 represents a significant achievement in the Android tablet market. It successfully delivers a premium tablet experience at a competitive price point, challenging the notion that excellence must come with a premium price tag. The thoughtful combination of hardware specifications, software features, and innovative accessories creates a compelling package that serves multiple use cases effectively.

The Pad 7 isn't trying to be an iPad clone; instead, it carves its own identity in the market with unique features and capabilities that make it stand out. For anyone seeking a premium tablet experience without the premium price tag, the Xiaomi Pad 7 offers a compelling alternative that doesn't just compete – it excels.

The Pad 7 is a versatile tablet suitable for students, creative professionals, and general users, showcasing Xiaomi's maturity in the tablet market by enhancing user experience affordably.

The Pad 7 pricing is particularly compelling, with the base variant starting at Rs 27,999 and the nano-texture version at Rs 32,999. This positions the Pad 7 as

an exceptional value proposition, especially when compared to similarly specced competitors like the base iPad 10th gen, OnePlus Pad Go, and Galaxy Tab S9 FE.

The core question remains: Who should invest in the Xiaomi Pad 7? The base variant represents an exceptional value proposition for students and young professionals. The combination of performance, features, and price point makes it an ideal choice for academic work and early career needs. Even with the addition of the keyboard

and pen accessories, the total investment remains lower than comparable iPad configurations.

Creative professionals will find particular value in the nano-texture variant. The enhanced display technology, combined with the precise Focus Pen, creates an excellent platform for digital art and design work. While it may not entirely replace professional drawing tablets, it excels as a portable creative tool for sketching and ideation.

Entertainment enthusiasts will appreciate the combination of the high-resolution display supporting Dolby Vision and the powerful quad-speaker system. The substantial battery capacity ensures extended viewing sessions without the need for frequent charging, making it perfect for binge-watching your favourite content.

–Siddharth Chauhan

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon 7+ Gen 3 | GPU: Adreno 732 | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage 256 GB UFS 4.0 | OS: Android 15, HyperOS 2 | Display: 11.2" IPS LCD, 68B colours, HDR10, Dolby Vision, 3200 x 2136 pixels | Refresh Rate: 144 Hz | Cameras: 13 MP | Selfie Camera: 8 MP | Video: Up to 4K at 30 fps | Battery Capacity: 8,850 mAh | Charging: 45 W (wired)

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